



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Haiti. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great place to start—thank you for sharing your background. At 16, finishing **primary school (folkeskolen)** in Denmark typically means you've completed the **9th or 10th grade**, and now you're deciding what upper secondary education to pursue. Your decision will depend on your **interests, career goals**, and **how you like to learn** (hands-on, academic, creative, etc.).

Here's an overview of the **main educational paths in Denmark after primary school**, with advice tailored to someone in your position:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These are academic programs that prepare you for **university**. They usually last **3 years**.

STX (Studentereksamen)

- Focus: Broad academic subjects (languages, humanities, science, social science).
- Good if: You want to keep your options open or go to university.
- Strength: Balanced education, suitable for many university programs.

HTX (Teknisk studentereksamen)

- Focus: Science, technology, and innovation.
- Good if: You enjoy subjects like physics, biology, math, and technology.
- Strength: Leads well into technical university degrees.

HHX (Handelsskolens studentereksamen)

- Focus: Business, economics, and international trade.
- Good if: You're interested in business or economics.
- Strength: Great for university or starting a business career.

HF (Højere Forberedelseksamen)

- Duration: 2 years (shorter).
- Focus: Similar to STX, but shorter and more focused.
- Good if: You want a faster route to higher education.

- Strength: More mature environment, flexible learning.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education & Training – EUD)

These are **practical programs** where you combine school and apprenticeship (praktik).

- Duration: 2-5 years depending on the field.
- Fields: Mechanics, hairdressing, IT, health care, construction, etc.
- Good if: You like **hands-on learning** and want to **enter the job market faster**.
- Bonus: You earn money during your apprenticeship (praktikplads).
- You can still go to university later (via EUX or after finishing).

EUX – Vocational + Academic (Best of both worlds)

- Combines EUD with subjects from gymnasium.
- Leads to both a skilled trade and eligibility for university.
- Good if: You want a **trade + future study options**.

What to Consider

Your Strengths

- Are you more academic or hands-on?
- Do you enjoy sciences, business, technology, or helping people?

Your Goals

- Do you want to go to **university**?
- Or do you want to **start working** earlier?
- Do you want to **start your own business** someday?

Your Passion

- What excites you? Technology, social work, design, mechanics, law, economics?

Example Paths Based on Interests

Interest	Suggested Path
Academic & university-oriented	STX, HTX, HHX, or HF
Practical, hands-on	EUD (vocational)
Tech & Engineering	HTX or EUX Teknik

Interest	Suggested Path
Business & Finance	HHX or EUX Business
Helping people	EUD SOSU (Social & Health), STX with bio focus
Creative	STX with art/drama, or EUD in media/design

Bonus: Bilingual & Cultural Edge

Being fluent in Danish and having Haitian heritage is a **big strength**. You could:

- Pursue **international studies or language programs** (STX/HHX with French or Spanish).
- Work in **global business, translation, or diplomacy** later.
- Be a role model for diversity in Denmark's education or public life.

Final Advice

1. **Visit schools** (åbent hus) and talk to students.
2. Try a **short internship or bridge program (brobygning)** to explore.
3. Talk to a **UU-vejleder (youth education advisor)** – they help a lot at this stage.
4. Choose what **motivates you**, not just what others expect.

If you tell me more about your **interests, favorite school subjects, or future dreams**, I can give even more specific suggestions. Would you like that?